

The Dream Team

Discussion 01

Readings

This discussion is centered on select chapters from “**Peopleware: Productive Projects and Teams**” (3rd edition), by Tom DeMarco and Timothy Lister. Teamwork is a vast, complex subject that cannot be “covered” in a single discussion. Our objective is simply to consider the perspective of two experts and think carefully about how we might apply these ideas in our own teams.

Required

- 1) Ch. 21 – The Whole is Greater Than the Sum (5 pages)
- 2) Ch. 23 – Teamicide (7 pages)
- 3) Ch. 17 – Playing Well With Others (3 pages)

Recommended

There are connections throughout this entire book to the Learning Outcomes of this discussion – I encourage you to hand pick a few chapters that sound interesting to you to supplement your required readings! They tend to be quite short, so you should have no problem at all finding strong Connections for this discussion.

Learning Outcomes

- Based on a team’s description:
 - o Recommend at least one change to improve their likelihood of jelling
 - o Predict their long-term success in jelling and achieving healthy project sociology
 - o Recommend at least one strategy to improve project sociology that takes advantage of the diversity of the team members
 - o Criticize or defend a management decision regarding a team’s project constraints or environment based on the decision’s impact to the sociology of the team’s project
- Contrast the advantages and risks of working with a team in software development
- Identify at least one advantage of teams working in the same physical space